Already tapped?

It happens to careful people too. What matters now is speed, so work down this list.

1	**Stop talking.** Hang up, and stop replying to the message.
2	**Call your bank or mobile money provider.** Use the number on your card or in the official app, never the number in the message. Ask them to block the account.
3	**Change your PIN and passwords** from a phone or computer you trust.
4	**Keep the proof.** Do not delete the SMS or call log. Take screenshots.
5	**Report it** to the police on 999 or at your nearest station, as soon as you can.

Then tell someone

Shame is what keeps these crimes quiet. Tell your family and your friends what the message said. The next person it lands on may be your mother, or the neighbour who collects a pension.

Heads up: no signal for no reason?

If your phone suddenly loses service and you have no idea why, call your network from another phone straight away. It could be a SIM swap.

Share this

Show this page to one person this week. Read it out to anyone who struggles with small print. A two-minute chat at the kitchen table can do more than any leaflet.

Who to call

Botswana Police Service
Emergency: **999**, or visit your nearest police station

Your bank or mobile money provider
The number on your card or in the official app. Save it in your phone today, before you ever need it.

Botswana National CSIRT
+267 3685 548, info@cirt.org.bw
Monday to Friday, 07:30 to 17:00

BOCRA
+267 395 7755, www.bocra.org.bw

Where our facts came from

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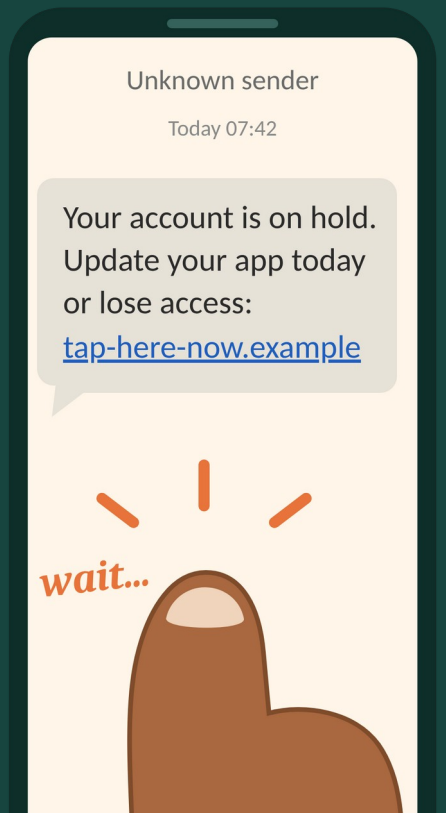
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Tapbrake is an independent awareness project. It is not run by, or linked to, any bank, network or government office.

Tapbrake

Brake before you tap.

A short guide to phone and mobile money scams in Botswana, and the ten seconds that stop them.



It started with one SMS

Your account is on hold because your bank app is out of date. Tap here to update it.

That, more or less, is the text Botswana Police warned about in 2025. People tapped the link, typed in their banking details, and criminals used those details to take their money.

In March 2025 a 54-year-old man in Maun lost over **P200,000** this way. In a similar case, a 46-year-old woman in Letlhakane lost close to **P160,000**.

Nobody falls for this because they are foolish. These messages are made to catch people who are busy, worried, or just holding a phone.

The numbers behind it

175	P8.16m	62%
fraudulent transaction cases in 2024	lost in those cases	of data breaches worldwide involved a human element

Why Tapbrake?

A scam only works in the second between reading and tapping. So we are not asking you to become a tech expert. We are asking for one thing: **brake before you tap.**

The Bank of Botswana says the elderly and the young feel these crimes most, and that pensioners are being targeted. This brochure is for them, and for everyone who looks out for them.

Four tricks to know

1. The fake bank text (smishing)

An SMS says your account is frozen or your app is out of date. The link leads to a copy of a real site, built to catch your details.

2. The "bank" on the phone (vishing)

The caller sounds professional and says there is a problem. A code lands on your phone, and they ask you to read it out. That code is the key to your account.

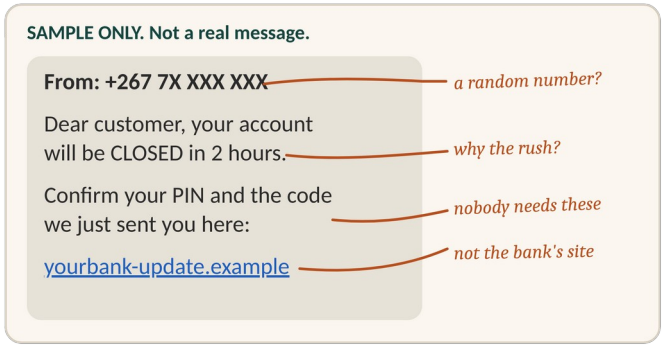
3. "You have won!"

A shop or company says you won a prize, but you must pay a fee first. Real winners are never asked to pay to collect.

4. SIM swap

A criminal talks your network into moving your number to their SIM. Your calls and codes then go to them.

Spot the fake



The BRAKE habit

Five small moves. Learn them once and they stay.

B	**Breathe.** Rushing you is the whole trick. Ten seconds costs nothing.
R	**Read it again.** Who sent this? Would they really ask for that?
A	**Ask someone.** Show a friend or relative before you act.
K	**Keep your codes.** PINs, passwords and one-time codes are yours alone.
E	**Exit and check.** Close the message. Call your bank on a number you already trust.

Ten minutes that help for years

- Put a PIN or fingerprint lock on your phone.
- Get apps only from the official app store.
- Use a different password for your banking.
- Switch on account alerts, so you see every transaction.
- Update your phone when it asks. Do it from Settings, not from a link.

Three tips for today

- Teach your parents the word "Tapbrake".
- Never pay to receive a prize or a refund.
- If it feels urgent, slow down.

Your bank has no need for your PIN or your one-time code. If someone asks, that is your answer.